

English 268
British Literature Since 1900:

The Long 1960s in Fiction and Film

Instructor: Rob Latham

Course Time: Wednesdays, 5:10-8:00 PM, in HMNSS 1407

Office Hours: Tuesdays & Thursdays, 3:30-4:45, & by appointment, in HMNSS 2014

E-mail: rob.latham@ucr.edu

Required Texts:

Colin MacInnes, *Absolute Beginners* (1959)

Iris Murdoch, *A Severed Head* (1961)

Anthony Burgess, *A Clockwork Orange* (1962)

Margaret Drabble, *The Millstone* (1965)

Jean Rhys, *Wide Sargasso Sea* (1966)

John Fowles, *The Magus* (1966)

J.G. Ballard, *The Atrocity Exhibition* (1970)

Angela Carter, *The Infernal Desire Machines of Dr. Hoffman* (1972)

Doris Lessing, *The Memoirs of a Survivor* (1974)

Description: This course examines selected British novels and films of the “long 1960s” in relation to contemporaneous debates regarding race, class, gender, and sexuality. These primary texts will be paired with secondary readings drawn from a range of discourses, including critical theory, history, sociology, and media studies. Overarching themes include the problem of class stratification, the emergence of gender and sexual liberation movements, the spread of counterculture values centering on spirituality and personal transformation, and the influence of new media cultures.

Requirements and Assignments: The first requirement is **preparation and attendance**. Because we meet only once per week, you should not miss class for any reason short of serious illness or other major emergency. Also, your consistent participation in dialogue—based on a focused and critical engagement with the course texts, contexts, and issues—is essential to the success of this class. An evaluation of your contribution to class discussion will form a major component of my assessment of your final grade.

Another requirement will be **in-class presentations**. These will involve two or three students per presentation, and each of you is required to participate in two presentations over the course of the term. The purpose of the presentations is to initiate and orient discussion of the texts we have read, and thus presenters should focus their remarks on these texts and not introduce unfamiliar material. Ideally, your responses should draw the primary texts into conversation with the secondary texts. Feel free to use these responses to stake out strong positions and to engage the assigned materials forcefully. The two or three students participating in each presentation should consult with one another in advance so that their work can be profitably divided up and their individual remarks dovetailed. Each co-operative presentation should take no longer

than 20 minutes, but their particular structure is up to the presenters: you can speak serially, or engage in critical dialogue, or whatever.

In terms of the written assignments, you have two options. You can produce **either a final research paper or a series of weekly reading responses and a shorter paper**. If you elect the first option, your paper should be roughly 25 pages in length (double-spaced, including notes and bibliography), should incorporate original research, and should focus on some aspect of British cultural production during the contemporary period. If you elect the second option, your response papers should briefly (in approximately one single-spaced page) record observations, ideas, questions, and/or criticisms inspired by the assigned texts. These responses must be sent to me via email no later than noon on Wednesday so that I have time to read them before we meet. If you are doing these responses, your final paper should be conference-length (around 12 double-spaced pages) and should develop an argument about or analysis of some selection of the assigned texts (e.g., a rigorous close reading of a single novel or film, or a comparative analysis of two or more novels or films, ideally in light of some critical perspective we have covered). You are welcome to bring in other materials not listed on the syllabus, though this is not required. Whether you choose to write a final research paper or a shorter conference paper, you are strongly encouraged to begin developing your projects as early as possible during the term. I will be available throughout the quarter to help you refine your ideas.

Reading Schedule:

Week 1. Working Class Angst

1/9: Primary Texts:

Doris Lessing, "The Small Personal Voice" (1957)

Alan Sillitoe, "The Loneliness of the Long Distance Runner" (1959)

Saturday Night and Sunday Morning (1960; dir. Karel Reisz)

Secondary Texts:

Richard Hoggart, *The Uses of Literacy: Changing Patterns in English Mass Culture* (1957) – excerpt

Paul Willis, *Learning to Labor: How Working Class Kids Get Working Class Jobs* (1977) – excerpt

Week 2. Subcultures

1/16: Primary Texts:

Colin MacInnes, *Absolute Beginners* (1959)

A Taste of Honey (1961; dir. Tony Richardson)

Secondary Texts:

John Clarke, Stuart Hall, Tony Jefferson, and Brian Roberts, "Subcultures, Cultures, and Class" (1975)

Paul Gilroy, "'Race,' Class, and Agency" (1987)

Robert J. Cross, "The Teddy Boy as Scapegoat" (1998)

Presentations: Liz Gumm, Simon Lee, Josh Pearson

Week 3. Youth in Revolt

1/23: Primary Texts:

Anthony Burgess, *A Clockwork Orange* (1962)

If... (1968; dir. Lindsay Anderson)

Secondary Texts:

Phil Cohen, "Subcultural Conflict and Working Class Community" (1972)

Graham Murdock and Robin McCron, "Consciousness of Class and
Consciousness of Generation" (1975)

Dick Hebdige, *Subculture: The Meaning of Style* (1979) – excerpt

Presentations: Daniel Ante-Contreras, Michael Jarvis, Lorenzo Servitje

Week 4. Bourgeois Pathologies

1/30: Primary Texts:

Iris Murdoch, *A Severed Head* (1961)

The Servant (1963; dir. Joseph Losey)

Secondary Texts:

Claire Langhamer, "Adultery in Post-War England" (2006)

Elizabeth Parzys, "Setting Up House in Joseph Losey's *The Servant*"
(2012)

Presentations: Taylor Evans, Alexander Kailani, Addison Palacios

Week 5. Single Girls

2/6: Primary Texts:

Margaret Drabble, *The Millstone* (1965)

Darling (1965; dir. John Schlesinger)

Secondary Texts:

Julia S. O'Connor, "Gender, Class, and Citizenship in the Comparative
Analysis of Welfare State Regimes" (1993)

Melanie Bell, "Young, Single, Disillusioned: The Screen Heroine in 1960s
British Cinema" (2012)

Presentations: Stina Attebery, Liz Gumm, Addison Palacios

Week 6. Desire and Destruction

2/13: Primary Texts:

Jean Rhys, *Wide Sargasso Sea* (1966)

Repulsion (1965; dir. Roman Polanski)

Secondary Texts:

Gayatri Chakravorty Spivak, "Three Women's Texts and a Critique of
Imperialism" (1985)

Andrew August, "Gender and 1960s Youth Culture: The Rolling Stones
and the New Woman" (2009)

Presentations: Taylor Evans, Lorenzo Servitje, Anne Sullivan

Week 7. Mysticism and Paranoia

2/20: Primary Texts:

John Fowles, *The Magus* (1966)

Blowup (1966; dir. Michelangelo Antonioni)

Secondary Texts:

Edward A. Tiryakian, "Toward the Sociology of Esoteric Culture" (1972)

Bart Moore-Gilbert, "The Return of the Repressed: Gothic and the 1960s Novel" (1992)

Presentations: Michael Jarvis, Raymond Rim, Danny Valencia

Week 8. The Society of the Spectacle

2/27: Primary Texts:

J.G. Ballard, *The Atrocity Exhibition* (1970)

Performance (1970; dir. Donald Cammell & Nicolas Roeg)

Secondary Texts:

André Jansson, "The Mediatization of Consumption: Towards an Analytical Framework of Image Culture" (2002)

Mattias Frey, "London à la Mod: Fashion, Genre, and Historical Space in *Performance*" (2006)

Presentations: Stina Attebery, Simon Lee, Josh Pearson

Week 9. Love is the Drug

3/6: Primary Texts:

Angela Carter, *The Infernal Desire Machines of Dr. Hoffman* (1972)

Women in Love (1969; dir. Ken Russell)

Secondary Texts:

Stevi Jackson & Sue Scott, "Sexual Antinomies in Late Modernity" (2004)

Andy Roberts, *Albion Dreaming: A Popular History of LSD in Britain* (2008) – excerpt

Presentations: Raymond Rim, Anne Sullivan

Week 10. Dystopian Visions

3/13: Primary Texts:

Doris Lessing, *The Memoirs of a Survivor* (1974)

Punishment Park (1971; dir. Peter Watkins)

Secondary Texts:

Bernard Duyfhuizen, "On the Writing of Future-History: Beginning the Ending in Doris Lessing's *The Memoirs of a Survivor*" (1980)

Andrew Hammond, "'The Twilight of Utopia': British Dystopian Fiction and the Cold War" (2011)

Presentations: Daniel Ante-Contreras, Alexander Kailani, Danny Valencia

Exam Week. Final Paper due 3/21 by 5 PM